

AI-ASSISTED CUSTOMER REQUEST WORKFLOW

Fictional example demonstrating practical AI use, human review, and operational control.

BUSINESS PROBLEM

High-volume customer requests create repetitive reading, note-taking, research, and drafting work. Manual handling slows response time and makes documentation inconsistent.

WORKFLOW GOAL

Use AI to accelerate repetitive cognitive work while keeping fact-checking, policy decisions, customer commitments, escalation, and final approval under human control.

WORKFLOW: AI ACCELERATES - HUMAN OWNS THE OUTCOME

STEP	STAGE	AI-ASSISTED ACTION	HUMAN CONTROL
1	Intake	Summarize the request, extract facts, identify missing information, and classify likely request type.	Verify summary against the source. Correct omissions or misclassification.
2	Context Review	Condense prior notes or a long thread into timeline, promises, open items, and known constraints.	Confirm the timeline and distinguish facts from assumptions.
3	Research	Search approved internal material or supplied references and surface potentially relevant guidance.	Select authoritative source. Do not rely on unsupported AI knowledge.
4	Draft	Create a concise response draft matched to the customer question, tone, and required next action.	Edit for accuracy, policy, empathy, commitments, and brand voice.
5	Document	Draft structured case notes: source, issue, action, status, owner, and next step.	Confirm notes reflect what actually happened and what remains open.
6	Close / Escalate	Suggest whether the issue appears routine, blocked, recurring, or escalation-worthy.	Human decides resolution, escalation owner, customer commitment, and closure.

EXAMPLE: TURNING AN UNSTRUCTURED REQUEST INTO ACTIONABLE WORK

SOURCE REQUEST	AI-ASSISTED EXTRACTION	HUMAN-APPROVED ACTION
<i>"I ordered last week and the tracking has not moved. I emailed yesterday but have not heard back. I need this before Friday. Can someone tell me what is happening?"</i>	• Issue: shipment/tracking delay • Urgency: needed before Friday • Prior contact: emailed yesterday • Open question: current shipment status • Next step: verify order/tracking + response history	• Verify actual order and carrier status • Review yesterday's contact before replying • Do not promise Friday delivery unless confirmed • Respond with verified status and next action • Document commitment and follow-up owner

OPERATING GUARDRAILS

AI MAY

Summarize, extract, organize, draft, compare, classify, and surface possible patterns.

AI MAY NOT

Invent facts, approve refunds, make policy exceptions, commit company resources, close sensitive cases, or replace required human judgment.

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